Module 3 Assessment Preview: Teacher Guide

Tools to **preview** the test and **teach** the skills it checks. This is not a modified test. Students practice every question type with a new article (“Busy Honeybees”) and a new letter, so the real test stays a true check of what they know.

What is on the test

Part	What students do	Items
Reading: article 1 (informational, 8 ¶)	7 questions: headings, multiple-meaning word, short written answer (bold words), sequence, Part A/Part B central idea, prefix **im-**, central idea of the article	1–7
Reading: article 2 (informational, 10 ¶)	6 questions: author’s purpose, Select TWO, context clues, signal words, multiple-meaning word, suffix **-er**	8–13
Reading: essay	Informational essay that explains, with evidence from article 2	14
Writing: revising and editing	A letter with numbered sentences. Commas in a series (write and choose), verb tense, abstract nouns, word choice	W1–W6

How to preview the real test

Show students the real test booklet (or project one page at a time) **before** test day, with the questions covered or only the first lines showing. Point out: the numbered paragraphs, the headings, the sentences shown in the middle of the page, “Select TWO,” Part A and Part B, the lined pages and planning page for the essay, and the numbered sentences in the letter. Knowing what the pages look like lowers stress, and students can spend their energy on reading.

5-Day Preview Plan

About 30 minutes a day. Student page numbers are at the bottom of each page.

Day	Teach (I do → we do → you do)	Student pages
1	Tour the test (cover the answers). Teach the Test Plan and Question Decoder. Model reading “Busy Honeybees” with stop-and-jot boxes.	1–5
2	Text features (headings, bold) and the short written answer with ACE. Text structure and author’s purpose.	6–7
3	Central idea (paragraph and whole article), Part A/Part B, Select TWO. Word detective: multiple-meaning words, prefixes, suffixes, context clues.	8–10
4	Practice questions 1–12 together, then partners. Always ask: “Prove it. Which paragraph?”	11–15
5	Plan and write the model essay together. Editing rules and the practice letter. Hand out bookmarks.	16–21

Make every lesson stick

• **Say it, show it, do it:** read each strategy aloud, point to it on the page, then have students do it with a pencil.
• **Think aloud** as you answer. Students need to hear how a reader rules out wrong answers.
• **“Prove it”** is the routine for every answer: students write the paragraph number next to their choice.
• Keep the strategy pages out on test day if your classroom test allows it.

Students with IEPs or 504 plans

Use these same pages and give each student’s usual supports while you teach, so test day feels familiar: reading aloud, chunking a passage into stop-and-jot parts, a reading guide or line tracker, highlighter for key words in the question, short movement breaks after each passage, and a scribe or speech-to-text for the essay. During the test, use only the supports listed in the student’s plan.

Test Map: Item → Skill → Strategy

Teach the skill with the practice item. Do not preview the real items' answers.

Test item	Skill	What students should do	Practice
1	Text features: headings	A heading tells what **that part** is mostly about.	Q1
2, 12	Multiple-meaning words	Try each meaning in the sentence. Keep the one that makes sense.	Q2, Q11
3	Short answer: why bold?	ACE: bold marks **important words** the author explains. Cite the sentence that tells the meaning.	Q3
4, 11	Text structure: sequence	Signal words (first, next, then, finally) show **steps in order**.	Q4
5	Part A/B: central idea of a paragraph	Answer A, then find the sentence that proves A.	Q5
6	Prefix **im-**	im- = **not**. Cover the prefix, define the base word, add "not."	Q6
7	Central idea of the article	The umbrella answer covers **every** part, not one detail.	Q7
8	Author's purpose	Inform: to **explain** or teach. Look at what the whole article does.	Q8
9	Select TWO details	Find the idea first. Check each choice: Does it prove the idea? Circle two.	Q9
10	Context clues + -er	Read the sentences around the word. -er on an action word = a person who.	Q10
13	Suffix **-er**	-er on a describing word = **more** (cleaner = more clean).	Q12
14	Informational essay	Plan: central idea + 2–3 ways, each with evidence. Use the planner.	pp. 16–17
W1, W5	Commas in a series	Put a comma after each item in a list of three or more, before and/or.	p. 18
W2, W4	Verb tense	Find the time clue: last week → past (-ed), tomorrow → will.	p. 18
W3, W6	Abstract nouns	A feeling or idea you cannot touch: courage, joy, fear.	p. 18

Answer Key: Practice Items

Why the right answer is right, and how to rule out the others.

Q	Answer	Think aloud
1	C	The heading sits above ¶3, and ¶3 is all about the steps for honey.
2	C	“The bees fan their wings.” Bees cannot be a sports fan. They move air with their wings.
3	Model	The author uses bold for foragers because it is an important word. Right after it, the author explains: “Foragers are bees that fly out of the hive to find food in flowers.” Bold tells the reader to stop and learn the word.
4	B	First, next, then, finally = steps in order. A, C, D are true but not in ¶3.
5	A: B B: C	¶5 is about how bees help. The sentence that proves it: “This helps plants make fruits and seeds.”
6	D	im- = not. possible = can happen. impossible = **cannot** happen.
7	D	A, B, C are each one small part (raindrops). D covers the whole article (umbrella).
8	B	The article teaches facts about bees. It does not tell a story or ask you to buy anything.
9	A, D	Clean, feed, guard, sip, carry, fan = hard work. B and C are true but do not show work. E is not in the article.
10	A	“…are people who take care of bees.” The text tells the meaning. keep + -er = someone who keeps.
11	B	“Tiny wax rooms called cells” = small rooms in the hive.
12	C	happy + -er = happier = **more** happy.
W1	Rewrite	“We packed sandwiches, apples, and juice for our garden work day.”
W2	A	Yesterday is the time clue: past tense = **visited**.
W3	B	joy is a feeling you cannot touch (an abstract noun) and fits the sentence.
W4	D	Next Saturday is the future. **will plant** is already correct.
W5	C	Comma after each item before and: tulips, daisies, and sunflowers.
W6	A	pride is the feeling Grandpa has. The other choices are things you can touch.

Name _____ Date _____

My Reading Test Plan

Read these steps out loud with your teacher. Use them on every passage.

What is on my test?

☐ **Reading:** 2 articles that teach facts. Questions 1–13.
☐ **Essay:** I write to **explain** using facts from article 2. Question 14.
☐ **Writing:** a letter. I find and fix mistakes. Questions W1–W6.

1 **PEEK**

Look at the title, the **headings**, and the **bold words**. They tell what you will learn.

2 **PREVIEW**

Read the questions first (not the answers). Now you know what to look for.

3 **CHUNK**

Read one paragraph. Stop. Write 2–3 words or draw a sketch about it. Then read the next one.

4 **UNDERLINE**

Underline the key words in the question: paragraph numbers, **TWO**, **NOT**, **best**, **mostly**.

5 **PROVE IT**

Go back to the paragraph. Find the answer in the words. Write the ¶ number next to your answer.

6 **CROSS OUT**

Put an ✗ on answers that are wrong. Choose the **best** answer that is left.

Take your time. Careful readers beat fast readers. If a question is hard, make your best choice, put a star ★ by it, and come back later.

Name _____ Date _____

Question Decoder

Test questions use special words. Here is what they really mean.

When the question says…	It is really asking…	Where I look
What do the **headings** tell the reader?	What is each part mostly about?	The words under each heading
Why does the author use **bold**…?	Why are these words special?	The sentence after the bold word. It often tells what the word means.
Which **meaning** of the word ___ is used?	Which meaning fits this sentence?	The sentence in the box. Try each meaning in it.
Think about the **prefix** im- Think about the **suffix** -er	Use the word parts to find the meaning.	My Word Parts chart (page 10)
What is the **meaning** of ___ as it is used above?	Use clues to figure out the word.	The words before and after it
Why does the author use **sequence**…? …the words **first, next, finally**?	Why does the author tell things in order?	The steps in that paragraph
What is the **central idea**…?	What is it **mostly** about?	Paragraph question: that paragraph. Article question: the whole article.
Which sentence **best supports** the answer to Part A?	Which sentence proves my Part A answer?	The paragraph from Part A
Why did the author write the article?	What is the author's purpose?	What the whole article does: teach, tell a story, or try to convince
Which details support…? **Select TWO**.	Which two facts prove the idea?	Circle **two** letters. Not one. Not three.

Name _____ Date _____

What the Questions Look Like

Know how to mark each kind before test day.

Choose ONE

Looks like: Four answers: A, B, C, D. Only one is best.
My job: Cross out wrong ones ✗. Circle **one** letter.

Select TWO

Looks like: Five answers: A–E. Two are right.
My job: Check every choice. Circle **two** letters.

Part A and Part B

Looks like: Two questions that go together.
My job: Answer Part A. Then pick the sentence in Part B that **proves** Part A.

Read the sentence

Looks like: A sentence from the article is shown in the middle of the page.
My job: Read the sentence. Find it in the article and read the sentences around it.

Write on the lines

Looks like: A question with lines to write on.
My job: Use **ACE**: Answer, Cite ("The text says..."), Explain ("This shows...").

Essay

Looks like: A big question and pages to plan and write.
My job: Plan first. Central idea + 2–3 reasons with facts + closing.

Revising and editing

Looks like: A letter with numbered sentences (1), (2), (3)...
My job: Go to the sentence number. Read it with each choice. Pick the one that sounds and looks right.

Choose the word

Looks like: A box of choices sits in the middle of a sentence.
My job: Read the sentence with each word in the blank. Choose the one that fits.

Name _____ Date _____

Read the article. Stop after each paragraph and jot in the box.

Busy Honeybees

1 Have you ever seen a bee buzzing from flower to flower? That bee is not just playing. It is working hard! Honeybees live and work together in a home called a **hive**. One hive can have thousands of bees.

¶1 2–3 words or a sketch

Jobs in the Hive

2 Every bee in a hive has a job. The **queen bee** lays all of the eggs. **Worker bees** clean the hive, feed the baby bees, and guard the door. Some worker bees are **foragers**. Foragers are bees that fly out of the hive to find food in flowers.

¶2 2–3 words or a sketch

How Bees Make Honey

3 Bees follow steps to make honey. First, a forager sips a sweet juice called **nectar** from a flower. Next, she carries the nectar back to the hive. Then, other worker bees put the nectar into tiny wax rooms called cells. Finally, the bees fan their wings to dry the nectar until it turns into thick, sticky honey.

¶3 2–3 words or a sketch

PEEK check: What do the headings tell you this article will teach? Is it a story, or does it teach facts?

Name _____ Date _____

4 It may seem impossible, but one bee makes only a tiny bit of honey in her whole life. It is less than one spoonful! That is why a hive needs so many bees working together.

¶4 2–3 words or a sketch

Bees Help Us

5 Bees help people and plants, too. When a bee visits a flower, yellow dust called **pollen** sticks to her body. She carries the pollen to the next flower. This helps plants make fruits and seeds. Without bees, we would have fewer apples, berries, and pumpkins.

¶5 2–3 words or a sketch

6 Beekeepers are people who take care of bees. They build safe boxes for hives and check that the bees are healthy. You can help bees, too! Plant flowers in your yard, and the bees in your neighborhood will be happier.

¶6 2–3 words or a sketch

Stop and think

In your own words, what is this **whole** article mostly about?

Name _____ Date _____

Lesson: Headings and Bold Words

Headings

A **heading** is a small title above a part of an article. It tells what **that part** is mostly about.

Example: The heading Jobs in the Hive is above ¶2. ¶2 tells the jobs of the queen and the worker bees.

Bold words

Authors use **bold** type for **important words**. Bold means: "Stop! Learn this word." The author usually tells what the word means in the same sentence or the next one.

Example: "…a sweet juice called **nectar**." The bold word is nectar. The clue tells me nectar is a sweet juice.

Writing a short answer: ACE

A = **Answer** the question in a full sentence. Use words from the question.
C = **Cite** evidence: "In paragraph __, the text says, '…'"
E = **Explain** how your evidence proves your answer: "This shows…"

Model (we do together): Why does the author use bold for the word hive in ¶1?

> **A:** The author uses bold for hive because it is an important word to know. **C:** In paragraph 1, the text says that bees "live and work together in a home called a **hive**." **E:** This shows that a hive is a bee's home, and the bold helps me notice and learn the word.

Name _____ Date _____

Lesson: How and Why Authors Write

Sequence structure

When an author tells things **in order**, the structure is **sequence**. Look for signal words:
first → next → then → after that → finally

Why does an author use sequence? To show the **steps** someone takes, in order.

Try it: Reread ¶3 of "Busy Honeybees." Box the signal words. Then write the steps.

First	→	Next	→	Then	→	Finally

Author's purpose: Why did the author write it?

To inform / explain = teach facts about a topic. (Articles like the ones on your test!)
To entertain = tell a story.
To persuade = try to get you to think or do something.

Tip: Think about the **whole** article. Wrong answers often talk about only one paragraph. Be careful with choices that start "to tell people to…". That is persuading, not explaining.

Try it: Why did the author write "Busy Honeybees"? Finish the sentence.

The author wrote the article to _____

Name _____ Date _____

Lesson: Central Idea

The umbrella test

The **central idea** is what the text is **mostly** about. It is like an umbrella: it covers **every** part.
A **detail** is like one raindrop: it is true, but it is only one small part.

• Central idea of a **paragraph**: what do **all** the sentences in that paragraph talk about?
• Central idea of the **article**: what do **all** the headings and parts talk about?

Try it: Sort these for “Busy Honeybees.” Write **U** for umbrella or **R** for raindrop.

_____ Bees fan their wings.

_____ Honeybees work together in many ways that help the hive and help us.

_____ Beekeepers build boxes for hives.

_____ The queen bee lays the eggs.

Name _____ Date _____

Lesson: Part A, Part B, and Select TWO

Part A and Part B

Part A asks a question. **Part B** asks which sentence **proves** your Part A answer. **Check:** Read your Part A answer, then say “because…” and read your Part B sentence. Do they match? If not, fix one of them.

Select TWO

1. Read the idea in the question. 2. Read each choice and ask: **Does this prove the idea?** Write yes or no next to it.
3. Circle the **two** yeses. A choice can be true and still not prove the idea!

Try it together: Idea: Worker bees have many jobs. Write yes or no. Circle TWO.

_____ **A** Worker bees clean the hive.

_____ **B** The hive can have thousands of bees.

_____ **C** Worker bees guard the door.

_____ **D** Pollen is yellow dust.

Check it: Say the idea + “because” + your two choices. Do they prove it?

Try Part A/B together: Part A: What is ¶2 mostly about? Every bee in a hive has a job. Part B: Which sentence proves it? Underline it in ¶2 on page 4.

Name _____ Date _____

Lesson: Word Detective

Multiple-meaning words

Some words have more than one meaning. **Try each meaning in the sentence.** Keep the one that makes sense.

guard "Worker bees guard the door."
✗ a person whose job is to keep a place safe (a noun, not an action here)
✓ to watch and protect something

Context clues

Read the sentence **before**, the sentence **with** the word, and the sentence **after**. Authors often tell you the meaning with words like is, are, called, means, which, or who.
Example: "Some worker bees are **foragers**. Foragers **are** bees that fly out…"

My Word Parts chart (Cover the prefix or suffix. Read the base word. Put it back together.)

Word part	Means	Example	Your turn
im- (prefix)	not	im + polite = **impolite** = not polite	imperfect = _____
un- (prefix)	not	un + happy = **unhappy** = not happy	unsafe = _____
re- (prefix)	again	re + read = **reread** = read again	refill = _____
-er on an action word	a person who	teach + er = **teacher** = a person who teaches	farmer = _____
-er on a describing word	more	tall + er = **taller** = more tall	colder = _____

Watch out for -er! Action word (teach, farm, keep) → a **person** who. Describing word (tall, cold, clean) → **more**.

Name _____ Date _____

Use “Busy Honeybees.” **Prove it:** write the ¶ number next to each answer.

1 What does the heading **How Bees Make Honey** tell the reader?

- (A) what the title of the article is
- (B) how many bees live in a hive
- (C) what that part of the article is mostly about
- (D) which words in the article are hardest

2 Read the sentence from paragraph 3.

> Finally, the bees **fan** their wings to dry the nectar until it turns into thick, sticky honey.

Which meaning of the word **fan** is used above?

- (A) a person who loves a sports team
- (B) a machine that blows air
- (C) to move air by waving something
- (D) a folded paper you hold

3 In paragraph 2, the author uses bold type for the word **foragers**. Why does the author use bold for this word? Support your answer with evidence. Use ACE.

Name _____ Date _____

4 Why does the author use sequence structure in paragraph 3?

- (A) to tell what the queen bee does
- (B) to show the steps bees take to make honey
- (C) to explain why bees are important
- (D) to show where bees find flowers

5 This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A What is the central idea of paragraph 5?

- (A) Bees have yellow dust on them.
- (B) Bees help plants make fruits and seeds.
- (C) People like to eat apples and berries.
- (D) Bees fly from the hive to many flowers.

Part B Which sentence from the article **best supports** the answer to Part A?

- (A) “When a bee visits a flower, yellow dust called pollen sticks to her body.”
- (B) “She carries the pollen to the next flower.”
- (C) “This helps plants make fruits and seeds.”
- (D) “Beekeepers are people who take care of bees.”

Hint: Read your Part A answer, say “because,” then read your Part B sentence. Do they match?

Name _____ Date _____

6 Read the sentence from paragraph 4.

> It may seem **impossible**, but one bee makes only a tiny bit of honey in her whole life.

Think about the prefix **im-**. What is the meaning of **impossible**?

- (A) very easy
- (B) very funny
- (C) able to happen
- (D) not able to happen

7 What is the central idea of the article?

- (A) Bees live in hives.
- (B) Bees fan their wings to make honey.
- (C) Beekeepers keep bees safe.
- (D) Honeybees work hard in many ways that help the hive and help people.

8 Why did the author write the article?

- (A) to tell people to buy honey
- (B) to teach facts about honeybees
- (C) to tell a funny story about a bee
- (D) to show how to build a beehive

Name _____ Date _____

9 Which details support the idea that bees are hard workers? **Select TWO** correct answers.

- **A** Worker bees clean, feed baby bees, and guard the door.
- **B** Bees live in a hive.
- **C** Pollen is yellow dust.
- **D** Bees fan their wings to dry the nectar.
- **E** Bees sleep all winter.

Hint: Write yes or no next to each choice first. Then circle the two yeses.

10 Read the sentence from paragraph 6.

> **Beekeepers** are people who take care of bees.

What is the meaning of **beekeepers** as it is used above?

- **A** people who look after bees
- **B** people who are afraid of bees
- **C** bees that make honey
- **D** boxes where bees live

Name _____ Date _____

11 Read the words from paragraph 3.

> …tiny wax rooms called **cells**.

Which meaning of the word **cells** is used above?

- (A) phones you carry
- (B) small rooms in a beehive
- (C) rooms in a jail
- (D) tiny parts of the body

12 Read the sentence from paragraph 6.

> Plant flowers in your yard, and the bees in your neighborhood will be **happier**.

Think about the suffix **-er**. What is the meaning of **happier** as it is used above?

- (A) not happy
- (B) a person who is happy
- (C) more happy
- (D) happy again

Check my work

☐ I answered every question.
☐ I wrote a ¶ number next to my answers to prove them.
☐ I circled **two** letters for Select TWO.
☐ My Part B sentence proves my Part A answer.
☐ I went back to every question with a star ★.

Name _____ Date _____

Lesson: Writing an Essay That Explains

On the test you will explain how a person's work helps something, using facts from the article.

Part	What I write	Sentence starters
Introduction	Hook + **central idea** (the answer to the prompt in one sentence)	Did you know…? ___ helps ___ in many ways.
Body 1	First way + evidence from the article + explain	One way ___ is… The article says…
Body 2	Second way + evidence + explain	Another way ___ is… In paragraph __, …
Body 3	Third way + evidence + explain	Also, … This shows that…
Conclusion	Say the central idea again in new words	As you can see, … That is why…

Model prompt: Explain how bees help people and plants.

Model essay (read it together and label each part)

Did you know that a tiny bee can do a big job? Bees help people and plants in many important ways.

One way bees help is by moving pollen. In paragraph 5, the article says that a bee "carries the pollen to the next flower." This helps plants make fruits and seeds.

Another way bees help is by making honey. In paragraph 3, the article explains that bees dry nectar "until it turns into thick, sticky honey." People can enjoy that honey.

Bees also help us have food to eat. The article says that without bees, "we would have fewer apples, berries, and pumpkins." This shows that many foods depend on bees.

As you can see, bees are small, but they help people and plants every day. That is why we should plant flowers and take care of bees.

Before you write: Plan on the planning page. **After you write:** Reread. Capital letters? End marks? Did I use facts from the article?

Name _____ Date _____

My Essay Planner

Prompt: Explain how _____ helps _____.

Central idea _____ helps _____ in many ways.

Way 1 Evidence (¶ __):

Way 2 Evidence (¶ __):

Way 3 Evidence (¶ __):

Closing As you can see,

Check my essay

☐ I wrote my central idea. ☐ I gave 2–3 ways. ☐ I used facts from the article and said the ¶ number. ☐ I wrote a closing. ☐ Capitals, end marks, spelling.

Name _____ Date _____

Lesson: Editing Rules for the Writing Test

Commas in a series

When you list **three or more** things, put a comma after each one before and or or.
✗ I like red blue and green.
✓ I like red**,** blue**,** and green.
Trick: Say the list out loud. Put a comma where you take a small breath.

Verb tense: find the time clue

Look for a word that tells **when**.
Past (already happened): yesterday, last week, ago → add **-ed**: walk → walk**ed**
Present (happens now or always): today, every day → walk / walks
Future (will happen): tomorrow, next week, soon → **will** walk
Remember: "No change is needed" is sometimes the right answer!

Abstract nouns

A **concrete noun** is something you can see or touch: beach, water, dog.
An **abstract noun** is a feeling or idea you **cannot** touch: courage, happiness, fear, pride, joy, kindness, friendship.
Clue: Many abstract nouns end in **-ness**, **-ship**, or **-dom**.

Try it: Sort the words. Write each one in the right column.

kindness rock joy pencil bravery tree love shoe

Concrete (I can touch it)	Abstract (a feeling or idea)

Name _____ Date _____

Jada wrote a letter to her grandpa. Read the letter and look for changes she should make. Then answer the questions.

My Garden

(1) Dear Grandpa,

(2) I hope you are doing well. (3) My class is growing a garden at school. (4) We packed sandwiches apples and juice for our garden work day. (5) Yesterday, my class visit a big flower farm. (6) The farmer showed us how to plant seeds. (7) I was a little nervous, but I was brave and tried it.

(8) Next Saturday, Mom and I will plant flowers at home. (9) We will plant tulips daisies and sunflowers. (10) Planting with you last spring filled me with _____.

(11) Love,
(12) Jada

W1 Sentence 4 needs to be revised. Rewrite sentence 4 using commas.

_____

_____

W2 What change should be made in sentence 5?

- (A) Change visit to visited.
- (B) Change visit to visiting.
- (C) Change visit to will visit.
- (D) No change is needed.

Name _____ Date _____

W3 Jada wants to add an abstract noun. Which word best completes the sentence?

I was a little nervous, but I felt _____ when I planted my first seed.

- (A) dirt
- (B) joy
- (C) shovel
- (D) flower

W4 What change should be made in sentence 8?

- (A) Change will plant to planted.
- (B) Change will plant to planting.
- (C) Change will plant to plants.
- (D) No change is needed.

W5 What is the correct way to write sentence 9?

- (A) We will plant tulips daisies, and sunflowers.
- (B) We will plant tulips, daisies and, sunflowers.
- (C) We will plant tulips, daisies, and sunflowers.
- (D) No change is needed.

W6 Which word would be best to put in the blank at the end of sentence 10?

- (A) pride
- (B) seeds
- (C) dirt
- (D) spring

How I answer editing questions

1. Find the sentence **number** in the letter. 2. Read the whole sentence. 3. Read it again with **each** choice. 4. Use the rules: commas in a list, time clue for tense, feeling word for abstract noun.

Cut out a bookmark. Keep it next to you while you practice.

MY TEST PLAN

1 PEEK
title, headings, bold words

2 PREVIEW
read the questions first

3 CHUNK
read one ¶, stop, jot

4 UNDERLINE
TWO, NOT, best, mostly, ¶ #

5 PROVE IT
go back, write the ¶ #

6 CROSS OUT
✗ wrong answers, pick the best

Write: ACE
Answer • Cite • Explain

Word parts
im-/un- = not
-er = person who OR more

Editing
list → commas
time clue → tense
feeling → abstract noun

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